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General Comment

Generative AI has proven itself to be unreliable and almost universally disliked in any capacity regarding the creation of images, videos, or any other form of media. As soon as the public learns of AI's involvement in advertising or production, the company that shamelessly deemed the "final" product to be acceptable over the work of actual, skilled, educated humans, always faces significant backlash that results in lost profits, reputation, or both.

Allowing these AI models to steal the work of actual people in order to "train" them has resulted in countless jobs lost in the name of "cost-cutting", all in order to mass produce low quality slop that degrades the integrity of media everywhere. Not only this, but allowing generative AI to proceed unchecked will have grave consequences that reach far beyond merely putting artists out of jobs and further shredding what little remains of RELIABLE information available to the public. It also poses very real risks to national security, personal credibility and privacy, and so much more. Through the creation of deep fakes, propaganda imagery, false news articles, etc., we face a growing threat of misinformation, blatant theft, innumerable opportunities for scams and criminal activity, and other forms egregious misuse of a tool that is poorly understood and only becoming more and more widely available. Allowing the evolution and spread of such dangerous technology can and will influence every aspect of our daily lives in a negative manner.

AI can have many great uses when applied conservatively, and for very specific tasks. A great example would be the ability to map the structure of proteins like what AlphaFold has achieved. However, by essentially dismantling the entire purpose of copyright protection to allow for legal theft of any and every creative achievement that humanity has to offer, we not only cheapen the entire concept of art in general, (defined as "the expression or application of HUMAN creative skill and imagination, typically in a visual form such as painting or sculpture, producing works to be appreciated primarily for their beauty or emotional power") but we insult the works of all the great and influential artists who helped to build the world as we know it today.

All to eliminate jobs from hard-working Americans, allow for the emergence of dangerous misinformation, propaganda, more believable scams, low quality products, and the general decline of reliability, credibility, reputation, and public perception of American companies and government.

No one is fooled by the claims that eliminating copyright protection will somehow amount to increased national security. It's illogical at best, and downright absurd at worst. It's obvious that the proposal for this breach of privacy and disregard for creators' rights is nothing more than a selfish attempt by OpenAI to further their own agenda, and, through some ridiculous and twisted logic, justify their theft of data from millions of people. No doubt backed by plenty of monetary "incentive" to convince the corrupt to completely ignore the obvious problems and risks that come with such short-sighted legislation.

Do the right thing and shut this down before it sets a terrible precedent for the encouragement of theft, misinformation, diminishing quality of products and reputation, and the eventual collapse of what pathetic scraps of what some might call an "economy" we have left. Protect the U.S. and its citizens before it's too late.